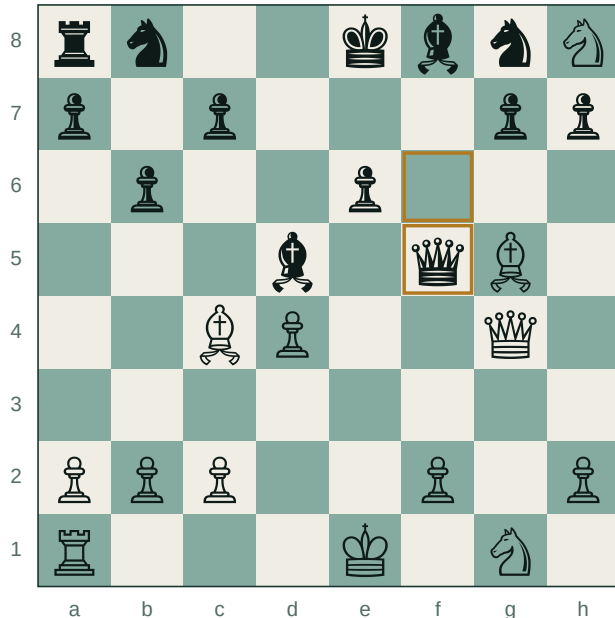


# Capture the defender: White, move 11

Capture the defender

White to move



Previous move: 10...Qf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 11. Qxf5 exf5 12. Bxd5

**11.Qxf5** The queen captures the queen on f5. From f5 it attacks bishop on f8 and bishop on d5. Recorded reply: **11...exf5**.

**12.Bxd5** The bishop captures the bishop on d5. From d5 it attacks rook on a8 and knight on g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not assume a defender is unique. Another piece may take over its job, or the opponent may decline to recapture.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Removing a key defender can transform a protected square into a winning entry. The defender's function explains why the first capture matters.

### HOW TO LOOK

Identify the protected target, capture its essential defender, and calculate the follow-up after each plausible recapture.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: knight on g8. Check for tactical protection.